Chapter 1

Some people said the town had not changed in a century, while others insisted that everything was different now. The library kept its doors open until nine, which made it the warmest place in town during the winter. Some people said the town had not changed in a century, while others insisted that everything was different now.

In the afternoon the light turned gold, and the old clock in the square ran four minutes late, as it always had. When the rain finally arrived, it fell for three days without a pause, and the fields became small lakes. The river town woke slowly, and the baker opened his shutters before the first cart rolled over the bridge.

Children walked to school along the canal, counting boats and arguing about which one was the fastest. A new road was planned for the spring, although the council had promised the same thing for eleven years. The river town woke slowly, and the baker opened his shutters before the first cart rolled over the bridge.

Most visitors came for the market, but a few stayed for the quiet streets and the long view of the hills. The library kept its doors open until nine, which made it the warmest place in town during the winter. By evening the market stalls were gone, and only the smell of bread and oranges remained in the square.

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Chapter 2

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